Self-Advocacy Worksheet for Parents

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

1. Understanding Self-Advocacy in Your Life

What does self-advocacy mean to you as a parent, both personally and professionally?

(Consider how self-advocacy plays a role in balancing your family responsibilities and work, as well as in ensuring your needs are met.)

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2. Advocating for Your Needs as a Parent

What are some of the key needs you have as a parent that may require advocacy?

(Think about your personal needs for self-care, time management, or support, as well as your children's needs, such as in education or healthcare.)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

How can advocating for these needs improve your well-being and ability to care for your family?

_____

_____

_____

_____

3. Advocating for Your Professional Needs

In your professional life, what needs do you have that you may need to advocate for?

(For example: flexible working hours, time off for family commitments, career advancement, etc.)

1. _____
2. _____

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Why is it important to advocate for these needs in your professional life?
(Consider the impact on your career, work-life balance, and long-term goals.)

4. Balancing Family and Work

Think about a time when you needed to balance work and family responsibilities. How did you advocate for yourself during that time?
(For example, did you request a flexible work schedule, delegate tasks at home, or ask for help from a colleague or family member?)

What could you do differently next time to better advocate for both your personal and professional needs?

5. Role-Playing a Self-Advocacy Situation in Your Personal Life

Imagine you need to ask for help at home (e.g., more support from your partner, time for yourself, help with children's activities). Write a short script for how you might approach this conversation.

You:

Partner/Family Member:

You:

Partner/Family Member:

You:

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6. Role-Playing a Self-Advocacy Situation in Your Professional Life

Imagine you need to request flexibility or support at work (e.g., a change in your schedule, the ability to work from home, or time off for family reasons). Write a short script for how you might communicate this need with your supervisor or HR department.

You: _____

Supervisor/HR: _____

You: _____

Supervisor/HR: _____

You: _____

7. Identifying Potential Barriers to Self-Advocacy

What challenges might you face when advocating for your needs at home or at work?
(Consider personal feelings like guilt, fear of judgment, or external challenges like company policies or family dynamics.)

_____

_____

_____

How can you overcome these challenges to advocate more effectively for yourself and your family?
(Write about practical steps you can take, like building confidence, seeking support, or improving communication.)

_____

_____

_____

8. Setting Goals for Self-Advocacy

What is one action you can take in the next week to advocate for your needs—either at home or at work?
(Choose one situation where you can improve your self-advocacy and describe the steps you'll take.)

_____

_____

_____

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Why is this action important for you and your family?

9. Supporting Your Children Through Self-Advocacy

How can you teach your children the importance of self-advocacy?

(Consider how you might model self-advocacy for your children, whether through communication, teaching them to ask for help, or empowering them to express their needs.)

10. Reflection on Your Self-Advocacy Journey

After completing this worksheet, how do you feel about advocating for yourself as a parent, both personally and professionally?

(Reflect on your confidence and the steps you plan to take moving forward.)

Final Thought:

Self-advocacy is a key skill for maintaining a healthy balance between your personal, family, and professional life. By being proactive in expressing your needs, you can create a positive environment where both you and your family can thrive!

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